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Graduate Recruitment Team

BGF Scotland

Edinburgh

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to ask to be considered for a graduate investment analyst role in Edinburgh or Glasgow. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. BGF's pledge to invest a further £200 million in Scottish businesses over the next five years, after being named in 2026 the most active investor in the UK's fastest-growing private equity-backed companies, makes its Scottish team one of the busiest growth investors near me.

My preparation for investing has come from taking deals apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, breaking down why the buyer wanted the asset, how the deal was structured and how the stake was valued. My strongest academic results reflect the same interest: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Private equity appeals to me because the investor owns the outcome: the thesis has to be delivered after the deal closes, not just argued before it. I have seen that side at a small scale. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, I created its house cocktails, set the specifications for its classics and trained around 15 bar staff to deliver them from launch. Before that, at KONG, I analysed sales patterns and refined our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. Both roles taught me that value is created in execution: in standards, training and small commercial decisions that compound.

BGF stands out to me because it takes minority stakes and works alongside founders rather than replacing them, an approach behind recent Scottish outcomes such as its exits from Entier and Optima Partners and a £15 million investment in Cruden Homes. Studying why investors back particular management teams has shown me how much of growth investing is judgement about people and execution, and I would be glad to support your Scottish team as an analyst.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan